Coder 3

Theme	Code	Description	Example
AI conceptualization/definition	*Statutory definition*	When they give a legal/formal definition of what counts as "AI"	"Artificial intelligence means an engineered or machine-based system that varies in its level of autonomy and that can, for explicit or implicit objectives, infer, from the input it receives, how to generate outputs" (California page 3)
	AI taxonomy provided	Document breaks down different types of AI (not just saying "AI" generically)	Table in California showing Generative AI vs Agentic AI vs General AI with definitions and examples (page 4)
	Distinguishes AI from other tech	Explicitly says what makes AI different from regular software/computers	"General-purpose language models differ from K-12 educational platforms designed specifically for school use under contract" (Connecticut page 11)
	Behind-the-curtain explanation	Tries to explain how AI actually works (algorithms, training data, etc)	"AI systems begin by processing large volumes and various facets of data such as text, images, and numbers. The AI then uses algorithms, sets of instructions, to analyze and interpret the data" (California page 3)
	No definition given	Doc uses "AI" throughout but never actually defines it	
Stakeholders (who these guidelines are for)	*Explicitly teacher-focused*	Language directly addresses classroom teachers, lesson planning	"Educators at all levels should develop an understanding of what AI is, how it works, its limitations, and its ethical implications" (California page 9)

	Administrator-focused	About district leadership, procurement, policy-making	"District-level AI governance should include: Adoption of local AI policies tied explicitly to MCA and ARM references" (Montana page 13)
	Board member audience	Written for school boards making governance decisions	"The Montana School Boards Association (MTSBA) provides complementary guidance for local policy development" (Montana page 12)
	Parent/family communication	Sections meant to inform or communicate with families	"Districts are encouraged to provide clear, accessible information (e.g., guides, workshops) to families" (California page 8)
	Student-focused	Actually talks to/about students as users	"Students, particularly children and youth, should be meaningfully engaged in conversations and decision-making" (California page 8)
AI tools and platforms	*Names specific companies*	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, etc explicitly mentioned	"including ChatGPT from OpenAI, Claude from Anthropic, and other forms of large language models (LLMs)" (Connecticut page 1-2)
	Generic tool categories	Talks about types but doesn't name brands	"Adaptive learning platforms, Intelligent tutoring systems, Grading assistants, Classroom chatbots" (California page 2)
	State-provided platforms	Tools the state itself offers to districts	"Montana Digital Academy (MTDA), via the Frontier Learning Lab" (Montana page 14)
	Vendor-neutral language	Deliberately avoids naming any products	
Equity and Access Considerations	*Rural infrastructure challenges*	Acknowledges broadband, staffing, or resource constraints specific to rural schools	"Small districts may lack dedicated technology staff, may have limited broadband infrastructure, and constrained budgets" (Montana, p. 12)

	Digital divide mitigation strategy	Specific actions to address unequal access (devices, connectivity, training)	"Prioritize funding and support for districts and schools that express interest in AI tools, particularly those serving high percentages of rural, tribal, or low-income students" (California, p. 10)
	Special education accessibility	AI tools to support students with disabilities (IEPs, accommodations)	"Speech-to-text applications help students with learning differences or physical disabilities gain independence" (California, p. 2/5 Equitable Access)
	Multilingual learner support	AI for translation, language scaffolding, or ELL services	"AI-powered captioning, transcription, and language translation tools remove barriers for multilingual learners" (California, p. 2/5 Equitable Access)
	Culturally responsive AI caution	Warns against AI undermining cultural relevance (esp. Indigenous education)	"While AI may support instruction, fulfilling IEFA requires educator expertise to ensure teaching strategies and content remain culturally relevant and respectful" (California, p. 10; Montana, p. 10)
Types of AI	*Generative AI*		
	Agentic		
	General AI (hypothetical)		
Governance and Authority Structures	*Local control emphasis*	Sentence affirms district/school-level decision-making authority over AI adoption	"Montana's commitment to local control means that AI decisions ultimately rest with individual school districts" (Montana, page 12)

	State-level coordination	Describes state role in providing resources, vetting, or technical assistance (not mandates)	"Establish state-level vetting or procurement guidance to support districts in selecting AI tools that meet privacy and security standards" (Montana, page 11)
	Constitutional/legal grounding	Explicit reference to state constitutional provisions governing education	"Montana's 'Constitutional Players' framework for governance of education distributes education authority across multiple entities" (Montana, page 12)
	Tribal sovereignty acknowledgment	Recognition of tribal government authority over AI use affecting tribal students/data/content	"Montana recognizes tribal governments across Big Sky Country, each possessing inherent sovereignty that predates the United States" (Montana, page 12)
	Multi-stakeholder governance model	Calls for advisory bodies, committees, or councils with diverse representation	"Convene a Diverse Team: Form a cross-functional committee of administrators, teachers, IT leaders, students, parents, tribal leaders, and community members" (Montana, page 15)
Tone or implementation language	*Mandatory directive*	Uses "must," "shall," "required", indicates compliance expectation	"Districts must ensure that AI integration is built upon a strong foundation of foundational literacies" (California, p. 7)
	Recommended practice	Uses "should," "encouraged," "may consider", advisory not binding	"LEAs are encouraged to prioritize in-person professional learning for AI instruction" (California, p. 7)

	Measurable timeline	Specific deadline or review cycle provided	"Annual compliance report to CA Dept of Public Health required by July 1, 2027" (California, p. 43)
	Vague/aspirational language	High-level principle without concrete action steps	"AI should be deployed to expand—not limit—educational opportunity" (California, p. 10)
	Phased implementation model	Explicit stages or sequencing for rollout	"Five-Phase Implementation Roadmap: Foundation → Policies → Capacity Building → Access → Monitoring" (Montana, p. 14)
External resources dependencies	*National education framework citation*	References ISTE, CSTA, CASEL, or similar U.S. education organizations	"AI4K12 outlines 5 Big Ideas of AI that provide foundational guidelines for deeper curriculum integration" (California, p. 16)
	International framework citation	References UNESCO, OECD, or non-U.S. bodies	"Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD). Empowering Learners for the Age of AI" (Montana, References, p. 18)
	Industry partnership mentioned	Names specific companies (OpenAI, Microsoft, Google) or encourages industry collaboration	"Google: LearnLM Tools" (Connecticut, Resources, p. 11)
	Peer state policy citation	References another state's AI guidance as model	"Massachusetts Department of Elementary and Secondary Education. Guidance for Artificial Intelligence in K–12 Education" (Montana, References, p. 18)

	Advocacy organization citation	References nonprofits like Digital Promise, Common Sense Media, ILO Group	"ILO Group: Artificial Intelligence Framework for District Leaders" (Connecticut, Resources, p. 11)